GYR-O Pages: call card

Devan Cherie Costa-Cargill · Wyoming SBDC, Powell · Fri 23 Oct, 1:00–1:30 · 307-254-7755 · dcostaca@uwyo.edu

THE ONE QUESTION

"Who at the University should I speak to, to have this reviewed?"

"If one of the PhD researchers there could review it, we'd be on the same wavelength, speaking the same language."

Send her to washakie-ai.online. The maroon link at the very top, "Abstract for our meeting today," opens the one-page summary.

SAY FIRST, ABOUT A MINUTE

- "Thanks for the time. I'm Walter Wilkinson, a retired technology engineer in Worland."
- "On June 3 of this year Governor Gordon issued an executive order calling for state agencies to promote data centers, the buildings AI runs on. But it looks like the state's AI money will be going to Cheyenne and Laramie. Here in Washakie County we will not be building any colossal data centers, and will not be hosting any AI researchers. My proposal answers the question: how can we bring AI to the grass-roots level?"
- "AI does the heavy lifting: simple single-topic websites, where the owner just picks a name. Three are live. If you open washakie-ai.online, today's abstract is the link at the very top. The technology is working now. What I'm looking for is the next step: the right people at UW, and funding for a county pilot."

Then stop talking. Let her ask. Before hanging up: one next step on the calendar.

ASK, IN THIS ORDER

1. **The one question** (above). If she asks who I have in mind:
   - **UW Extension:** the University's grass-roots arm, with an office in every county, Worland included; farms, ranches, 4-H, community development. *The most practical.*
   - **The UW AI Initiative:** the President's program, quoted on today's page; names agriculture, calls itself "people-centered." *The strategic fit.*
   - **Gabrielle Allen,** director, School of Computing: the one person the Initiative's page names; the School aims to give Wyoming businesses and citizens computing tools. *The most technical.*

   Then: "Would you introduce me, by a short email?"
2. **Market research.** Can the SBDC run it on this, free? What do you need from me?
3. **Sponsor.** Which Washakie County body has sponsored a Business Council grant before, and who there?
4. **The grant.** Is the $10,000 Community Economic Growth Grant open (its page still says "reopening by January 2024")? If not, what's the right one for a rural technology pilot?

IF SHE ASKS "BUSINESS OR COMMUNITY PROGRAM?"

> **"A business. The school pilot is the market test; the grant would fund the pilot."**

IN MY POCKET, ONLY IF IT COMES UP

- **Cost to an owner:** hosting free; the name $11–$28 a year; a farm cooperative can share one name.
- **The pilot:** 12 months, 12 working sites, 4 public workshops, method published free; students demonstrate, they don't build.